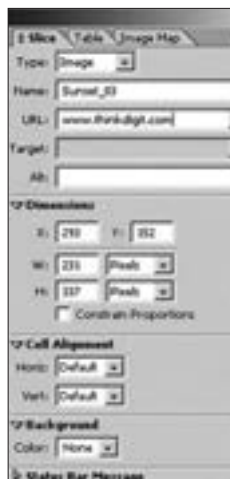


10.4 Slashing File Size With Slices

You will often find yourself sacrificing file sizes and download times just because some part of your image has a lot of detail and compressing it ruins its quality—for example, a photo of yourself against a clear sky. The sky will continue to look good under even the most aggressive compression, but your face is going to be reduced to a blotchy monstrosity. Thanks to ImageReady's Slices, you don't have to deal with this anymore. It lets you cut up the image into a number of smaller images, so you can optimise each one with the settings that suit it best—so you can apply very little JPEG compression to the area with your face in it, and a very brutal GIF compression to the sky around it.



The Slices Palette

Another handy feature of slices is the ability to turn individual slices into Web links—you can attach a URL to each of your slices, so when you post the lot on the Web, it will look like different areas of the image lead to different places.

10.4.1 The first cut

Use the Slice Tool ([K])  to make your first slice. The rest of the image will now fade away while ImageReady lets you edit the options for this slice. In the Slice palette, you can assign a URL to this slice, enter its pixel dimensions manually, enter “Alt” text for it (text that will be displayed on the page if the image doesn't load), and even specify a status bar message that will appear when the mouse cursor moves over the slice.

One of the first things you'll notice is that ImageReady automatically creates more rectangular slices for the rest of the image as well. However, you can only edit the size and position of the one